EMPLOYEE MOTIVATION AND JOB SATISFACTION

Clark Hull, one of America's most influential psychologists, demonstrated in detail in his 1943 book *Principles of Behavior* that an individual's behavior was an end product of several factors, chief among them being skill level, or ability (Hull's Habit Strength), and motivation (Hull's Drive). There have been many similar such assertions and findings since Hull. With proper selection and adequate individual and organizational training, the employee is likely to possess adequate skill levels for effective organizational performance. But what of his or her motivation? A number of work-related factors have typically been identified as major employee-motivation incentives and employee job satisfaction sources:

1. Work attributes, including intrinsic interest, variety, opportunity to use one's skills, opportunity for new learning, difficulty, amount of work, responsibility, control over work methods and pace, complexity, and opportunity for job enrichment
2. Pay, including its absolute amount and perceived fairness, method of payment, and comparative amount in relation to one's age, seniority, education, experience, effort expenditure, output quantity and quality, job challenge, and job responsibility
3. Promotion opportunities, their basis, fairness, and frequency
4. Recognition, including credit for work done and praise for accomplishment
5. Working conditions, including hours, rest breaks, temperature, noise, ventilation, light, humidity, location vis-à-vis home, cleanliness, physical layout, tools, and equipment
6. Supervision, its considerateness, fairness, style, and technical and administrative skill
7. Coworkers, their friendliness, helpfulness, and competence

To summarize, in the words of Locke (1976):

> Job satisfaction [and motivation] results from the attainment of values which are compatible with one's needs. Among the most important values or conditions conducive to job satisfaction are: (1) mentally challenging work with which the individual can cope successfully; (2) personal interest in the work itself; (3) work which is not too physically tiring; (4) rewards for performance which are just, informative, and in line with the individual's personal aspirations; (5) working conditions which are compatible with that individual's physical needs and which facilitate the accomplishment of his work goals. (6) high self-esteem on the part of the employee; (7) agents in the work place who help the employee to attain job values such as interesting work, pay, and promotions whose basic values are similar to his own and who minimize role conflict and ambiguity. (p. 1319)

Employee motivation and job satisfaction have been measured in a num-

ber of ways, including observation of overt behavior, rating scales, projective techniques, and, as illustrated in Table 5.2, action-tendency structured interviews.

Although efforts to more fully understand worker motivation and job satisfaction have relied on a variety of perspectives such as reinforcement theories, need theories, expectancy theories, two of the more influential approaches have been those put forth, respectively, by Maslow and Herzberg. Maslow's (1970) Need Hierarchy Theory proposes five basic levels of human needs: *physiological* needs, including air, food, water; *safety* needs, which include freedom from physical threats, economic security, and so on; *love and belongingness* needs; *esteem* needs, such as the needs for recognition, approval, mastery, and achievement; and the need for *self-actualization*, which involves fulfilling one's capabilities and aspirations. Maslow posited that these needs are ordered or hierarchically arranged in potency (as just listed), such that the less prepotent needs are neither desired nor sought until the more prepotent needs are satisfied or fulfilled. Although subsequent

Table 5.2. Sample Items for an Action-Tendency Interview Schedule for Job Satisfaction

1. When you wake up in the morning, do you feel reluctant to go to work?
2. Do you ever feel reluctant to go home from work at night because of the enjoyment you are getting from your job?
3. Do you often feel like going to lunch at work sooner than you do?
4. Do you feel like taking a coffee or rest break more often than you should?
5. Do you ever wish you could work at your job on evenings or weekends?
6. Are you sometimes reluctant to leave your job to go on a vacation?
7. When you are on vacation, do you ever look forward to getting back to work?
8. Do you ever wake up at night with the urge to go to work right then and there?
9. Do you ever wish holidays or weekends would get over with so that you could go back to work?
10. If you were starting over in your working career, would you lean toward taking the same type of job you have now?
11. Would you be tempted to recommend your present job to a friend with the same interests and education as yours?
12. Do you ever feel like just walking out on this job for good?
13. When you are at work, do you ever wish you could be somewhere else?
14. Do you think you will be reluctant to retire when the time comes, if you still have this same job?
15. Do you ever feel like working right through lunch break?
16. Do you ever feel like going home early from this job?
17. When you are on your way to work, do you ever feel like going somewhere else instead?
18. How would you feel about working overtime at this job without extra pay?
19. If you inherited a million dollars tomorrow, how would you feel about keeping this job?
20. Would you like to find a better job than this one as soon as possible?

Note. From "Nature and Causes of Job Satisfaction" by E. A. Locke in *Handbook of Industrial and Organizational Psychology* (p. 1336) edited by M. D. Dunnette, 1976, New York: Wiley Interscience. Copyright 1976 by Wiley Interscience. Reprinted by permission.

research has demonstrated only mixed support in industrial contexts for Maslow's perspective (Alderfer, 1972; Wahba & Birdwell, 1976), it has nevertheless continued to have a substantial impact on thinking and planning about worker motivation and job satisfaction in American industry.

In 1959, Herzberg, Mausner, and Snyderman, conducted a study of 200 engineers and accountants, who were asked to describe a time when they felt especially satisfied with their jobs and a time when they felt especially dissatisfied. Incidents involving factors intrinsic to the work itself—responsibility, recognition, advancement, a sense of achievement, and growth—were frequently mentioned as sources of job satisfaction. Herzberg et al. termed these *motivators*. Incidents classified as involving supervision received, interpersonal relations on the job, working conditions, company policies and salary, that is, the context in which the work is performed or factors extrinsic to the job itself, were frequently mentioned as sources of job dissatisfaction. These were labeled *hygiene* factors. As Locke (1976) noted,

> Thus, the theory argues that job satisfaction and dissatisfaction result from different causes; satisfaction depends on Motivators while dissatisfaction is the result of Hygiene factors. . . . The Hygiene factors operate only to frustrate or fulfill man's physical needs, while the Motivators serve to fulfill or frustrate man's growth needs. (p. 1310)

Human relations training, improved compensation arrangements, and better working conditions have (since the onset of the Human Relations Era) long been recognized as reducing job dissatisfaction. The motivation-hygiene theory of Herzberg et al. (1959), in contrast, enhanced the concern with motivation factors, especially in the form of job redesign, as the chief means of enhancing job satisfaction. Job redesign has found several concrete expressions, most of which are one form or another of job enrichment such as enhanced responsibility, recognition, autonomy, and sense of achievement.

The industrial employee, appropriately selected, adequately trained, and sufficiently motivated will ideally function on the job in a manner leading to high levels of productivity and job satisfaction. In this chapter's final two sections, we will consider how employee performance can be competently and fairly evaluated and, if found wanting, how ineffective performance can be improved.